

Investigating a vowel shift in progress in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec

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This article investigates a vowel shift in progress in Santiago Laxopa Zapotec's vowel system. Evidence from Pillai Scores and Bhattacharyya's Affinity show that the Sierra Norte Zapotec vowel /o/ is rising to /u/. Male speakers of Santiago Laxopa Zapotec have the largest divergence between [o] and [u] productions.

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1 Introduction

1.1 Vowel splits, mergers, and shifts

1.1.1 Previous research about splits, mergers, and shifts

1.1.2 Quantification through Pillai Scores and Bhattacharyya's Affinity

1.2 Santiago Laxopa Zapotec

1.2.1 Previous vowel research

2 Methods

2.1 Data collection

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3 Analysis

4 Results

4.1 Vowel space

4.2 Vowel overlap

4.3 Vowel shift

5 Conclusions

6 References